Millen Woods School Council
January 8, 2025 Meeting Minutes

Welcome & Introductions: Ashley

- Meeting called to order at 6:36
- Motion to approve agenda – Rachel
- Motion to approve December 2024 minutes – Erin

Admin Report: Karen

- Mrs. Moore is away until January 14th, a supply Secretary is currently working in the office
- Mme McCarthy started in room 22 and it's been a smooth transition for students
- December "Week of Fun" before the holidays with Bingo, colouring contest, Staff vs Student volleyball game with an option to go to the library, and Comfy Cozy day
- Staff happy to return to school to see their students - students reported being happy to be back!
- Generous donations of apples from parents for the snack program
- Basketball intramurals and grade 6 travelling team are about to start for juniors
- Chess club to start soon for primary and junior, most likely after reports cards are complete
- Teachers are writing report cards so it's a really busy time
- Our SCIS group will be presenting later this month on the 3rd Grandfather or Sacred Law from Anishinaabe culture which is Humility
- PROGrant application has been released, deadline for applications is January 24th, with funding announcements on February 14th. In past the value was $500.
- Looking to source wall decals of the various religions for the peace tree in the front Lobby
- Given a $500 grant for a French cultural event – staff are planning a Carnaval in February
- Staff continues to work toward our goals of improvement in math achievement and literacy.
- Playground RFP is underway - Procurement staff met with potential vendors who might submit a proposal so they could see the site. The evaluation process is robust and we have one Millen staff member and one Millen council member who will be part of the evaluation team.
- New supervision monitor Rosa has joined us as Meaghan McGloin has joined as a full-time EA, and 2 parents are on the supply list for the supervision monitor
- Kids who attended the all-day extended day camp for Jan 2 & 3 had great feedback. In general, the extended day program has provided structure and focused activities for the kids, and families are enjoying it.
- ESQube is running a free STEM event for all classrooms Grade 1 - 6 in March during the school day. We should consider using ESQ for one of our events next year to thank them for their continued support.

Finance Report: Ashley

- Will be updated and circulated when Ann is back

PRO Grant: Ashley

- PRO grant application is due January 24th

- Application will be put in for the planned arts night, under the STEAM category or arts and wellness angle. We are planning to combine the PRO and PIC grant funds and expect to have close to $1,000 for the program
- Last month we discussed the ArtShine program which was very reasonably priced – 3 booths set up in different classrooms with drop-in style art programs (drawing, sculpture, scratch art – we would consider replacing scratch art as we are doing that for winter wonderland). The cost is $700 plus HST which includes three instructors and materials for 300 projects per booth.

Action item: Ashley will ask Dan to write the application. We will finalize our plans and book ArtShine once we have notification that the grant has been successfully awarded.

Snack & Lunch Program Update: Ashley

- Apple program continues to go well
- ESNS – notice was published on School Day today that we have added options to the Thursday lunches for salads, gluten-free and meat-free options, etc.
- ESNS cheque should come in February for the December/January order window.
- February orders are now open and include the new options for Thursday.
- A popcorn order has been placed and flavours changed up per student requests to include white cheddar.

Action item: Ashley to touch base with Colleen about popcorn storage in the rubber maid containers instead of the cardboard boxes to avoid another mouse feast.

Fundraising Brainstorming: Erin/Rachel

- Fundraising ideas were discussed last month. A survey will be sent around to parents to gauge interest to guide next year's fundraising programs (see further discussion below)

Action item: Erin to send the fundraising sheet to Rachel, Rachel will populate the survey items and will send it to Ashley for review. Aiming to have results back for March/April.

Dance-a-Thon Student Survey: Karen

- Students were surveyed about whether they wanted to keep the dance a thon or change to a new event. The kids overwhelmingly want the dance a thon back. The kids were invited to share other ideas, but most of the ideas shared are already in place (winter play day, class reward days, etc.) so we will move ahead with the dance a thon in the same format as last year, with the second side of the gym open for alternative activities (cornhole, etc.)
- Rebecca suggested having glow sticks for purchase. Karen raised concerns about student equity since there are already photo booth strips for purchase. Suggested that we set a school fundraising goal, use a thermometer chart, and if the school raises the total funds then council will purchase enough glow sticks for all the kids
- Messaging to indicate that the funds are being raised towards a gaga ball pit for 2025-2026 school year installation (expected cost was around $3k last year, we have allocated $1,500 of this year's budget towards the gaga ball pit with the remainder of the funds to come from next year's budget)

Action item: Ashley to reach out to the DJ to get possible dates for March, and then coordinate with Karen for gym availability. ***Following the meeting, March 5th has been booked with the DJ for the Dance-a-thon! More correspondence to follow, and volunteers will be needed.***

Winter Wonderland Update: Emily/Daniella

- Glass Slipper will be providing entertainment - half hour Frozen interactive show
- Stations include: art mural, scratch art activity, cornhole fundraiser (toonie for a toss), hot chocolate station, tea station, and photo station. Families can purchase pizza for dinner ahead of time
- Cornhole funds raised will be split 50/50 between Millen Woods School Council and another school council in the Region. Kids will also get a small prize for landing their shots (stickers, erasers, etc).

Action item: Karen to arrange for the stage to be set up
Action item: Daniella to deliver a sample of the art paper to the school so Karen can test tape stickiness, and Karen will provide tape to attach the mural to the wall
Action item: Council to sign up for volunteer slots on the link circulated by Daniella
Action item: Karen to touch base with the board for schools that could use the funds, and coordinate with principals to ensure no other donations already exist
Action item: Rachel to send communication for pizza order reminders, volunteer sign ups, remind families to bring toonies, indicate toonies are for fundraising split 50/50 MW and a school in need

School Photos Discussion: Karen

- Karen has been in contact with both companies and is looking for a volunteer to help compare pricing, details, reviews, etc.

Action item: Karen/Ashley to ask if Dan would be willing, if not then PRadeep is the backup. ***Following the meeting, Dan has agreed to complete the comparison.***

Math and Literacy: Karen

- Deferred to next meeting

Spring Fundraiser: All

- Winter fundraiser will be the dance a thon
- Spring fundraiser is budgeted to bring in $500
- Council discussed doing the Warren's Greenhouse pansy fundraiser, but orders need to be in for March, so the timing overlaps with dance a thon. Decided to defer the pansy fundraising idea to next school year.
- Ice cream sandwiches netted approximately $900 last year for 3 weeks, and was very well received by the students. Council decided to move forward with this for this year and will send the parent survey around to source ideas for next year's fundraising programs. We have a write-up from Kyla last year for the process she followed, the cost of the ice cream, and where she sourced it. When

the school day communication is sent out, we should include a line that if kids have allergies, to contact the office for an alternative. Gluten-free, dairy-free and regular will be offered for purchase. Planning to offer 2 weeks in each of April, May and June

- Survey for next school year to be sent out with responses to close in April

Action item: Put ice cream sandwiches on the March agenda to figure out the details

Adjournment: Ashley

- Meeting adjourned

Next meeting: February 12th at 6:30 in person with virtual link

MILLEN WOODS SCHOOL COUNCIL
ATTENDANCE SHEET FOR January 8, 2025

#	Name	Position	Email	Initial for Attendance
1.	Karen Grant-O'Grady	Principal	karen_grantogrady@wrdsb.ca	KGO
2.	Ashley Feeney	Co-Chair	ashleylfeeney@gmail.com	AF
3.	Emily Lutz	Co-Chair	emilywyss@gmail.com	EL
4.	Erin Evans	Co-Secretary	erinnfranklin@gmail.com	EE
5.	Steph Honour	Co-Secretary	stephaniemhonour@gmail.com	SH
6.	Raj Pancha	Treasurer	Rajathepan@hotmail.com	online
7.	Sarah Nickel	Co-Communications Officer	nickelsarahm@gmail.com	Regrets
8.	Rachel Sarchielli	Co-Communications Officer	sarchrachel@gmail.com	RS
9.	Jake Billo	Technology Officer	jake@billo.ca	online
10.	Colleen Araya	Volunteer Coordinator	colleenmw@hotmail.com	
11.	Dan Collens	Voting	dan.collens@gmail.com	
12.	Pradeep Chandran	Voting	pradeep24s@gmail.com	PC
13.	Kristen Smith	Voting	kj_martin@hotmail.com	Regrets
14.	Daniella Cross-Henderson	Voting	daniellacross@gmail.com	Online
15.	Julia Klein	Voting	julia.kleinhb@gmail.com	
16.	Maryam Elsabagh	Voting	maryam_rashad@hotmail.com	
17.	Nicolas Mellet	Voting	nicolas.mellet@net.com	
18.	Sandra Ribes	Voting	mrs.s.ribes@gmail.com	
19.	Sarah Boss	Non-Voting	Slouboss@gmail.com	
20.	Hamed Hashemi	Non-Voting	s.h.hashemi65@gmail.com	
21.	Meaghan McGloin	Non-Voting	meaghan.mcgloin@gmail.com	
22.	Rebecca Kennedy	Non-Voting	re.mortlock@gmail.com	RK
23.				
24.				
25.				
26.				
27.				
28.				
29.				
30.				